Easy Peasy Plaid

by FiberFrosting Designs

These toe up socks have contrasting toe and heel, and some “easy peasy” plaid to top them off. The plaid is done in two colors and is achieved using slip stitches, using only one color at a time. Easy, right? The plaid stitch pattern for the leg is from Barbara G. Walker's “Charted Knitting Designs, A third Treasury of Knitting Patterns”. I fell in love with the classic simplicity of it and knew it would be a great way to top off a pair of socks!

These socks are worked from the toe up, two at a time, using magic loop method. This pattern is intended for a knitter that already is familiar with:

- the magic loop method, or comfortable using another method (double points, two circs) and substituting in pattern.
- the Turkish cast on method, or other cast on method of choice for toe up.

If you are not familiar with the Magic Loop method or the Turkish cast on and would like to learn about either one, here is a good Turkish cast on and magic loop tutorial:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zrUTWaIgdMk

Just remember that the number of wraps around the two needles is half the total stitches the pattern says to cast on (each full wrap represents 2 stitches; one on each needle).

Gauge in stockinette:

9 sts/inch, 12 rows/inch, (9 st per 2.54cm, 12 rows per 2.54cm) with larger needle.

Sizes: Women's **s** (**m**, **l**, **xl**). To fit foot circ. of: **7.5** (**8**, **9**, **10**) inches or **19** (**20**, **23**, **25.5**) cm

Supplies:

Yarn: Fingering weight sock yarn, in two colors, one skein of each color, split into 2 balls each. For larger sizes with longer cuffs, 2 skeins of the main color might be required.

Needles:

US 1 (2.25mm) 36-40" (81-101mm) circular (for magic loop), or size needed to get gauge.

US 0 (2.0 mm) (36-40" (81-101mm) circular for cuff (or 1 size smaller than above gauge needle size)

Other: 3 Stitch markers, tape measure or ruler, and darning needle to weave in ends.

TOE

With Color B,
Cast on **20** (**20**, **24**, **28**) stitches per sock using the Turkish cast on method (or other toe-up method of choice).

Rnd 1-**5** (**5**, **6**, **7**) :

Top: kfb, k to last 2 stitches of top, kfb, k1

repeat for other sock (be sure to drop sock 1 yarn and pick up sock 2 yarn).

Bottom: kfb, k to last 2 stitches of bottom, kfb, k1

repeat for other sock

Rnd **6** (**6**, **7**, **8**): knit all stitches of both socks (no increases).

Repeat last 2 rounds until there are **56** (**64**, **72**, **80**) stitches per sock.

Repeat last round 2 more times (knit even – no more increases).

*** Now is a good time to double check your gauge. ***

FOOT

Cut Color B, and attach Color A

Rnd 1: knit all stitches of both socks.

Repeat until ready to start heel. The length will vary, depending on several factors:

1. Gauge. If you are getting correct row and stitch gauge, no worries, no length adjustments will be needed for gauge. If not, you will likely need to do some math.
2. Another consideration before starting the heel is if you will do a 50% heel (for low-med instep) or a 60% heel (for higher instep). Instructions are provided for both.
3. Pattern sizing compared to desired sock length (for foot portion of sock). The pattern is written to create the sock lengths shown below (calculated to be approximately 95% of foot length for a small amount of negative ease).

   small: 7.6" [19.3 cm]
   med: 8.5", [1.6 cm]
   large: 9.5", [24 cm]
   xl: 10.5", [26.7 cm]

If you fall somewhere between these, adjust pre-heel sock length measurement below accordingly.

For 50% heel, knit until sock measures **6** (**6.5**, **7**, **8**) inches [**15.3** (**16.6**, **17.6**, **20.3**) cm] long.

For 60% heel, knit until sock measures **5.6** (**6**, **6.3**, **7.3**) inches [**14.3** (**15.2**, **16**, **18.3**) cm] long.

HEEL

Setup:

50% Heel Option: Knit across top of foot (still using Color A) of both socks.

60% Heel Option: With Color A, rearrange stitches to

First sock: k **2** (**3**, **4**, **4**), slide those stitches to back (heel side), k **24** (**26**, **28**, **32**), put remaining **2** (**3**, **4**, **4**) stitches onto stitch holder or scrap yarn.

Second sock: knit first **2** (**3**, **4**, **4**) stitches then put onto stitch holder or scrap yarn, k **24** (**26**, **28**, **32**), pull left needle through remaining stitches, moving them to the heel side of sock.

Work **complete** heel of one sock before starting the next, as follows:

First half of heel: IF DOING 60% HEEL, REMEMBER TO TRANSFER HELD STITCHES TO WORKING NEEDLE AS YOU ENCOUNTER THEM TO INCLUDE THEM AS HEEL STITCHES (yeah, I forgot to do this once...not a pleasant experience)

Row 1 (RS): k up to last 2 heel stitches,
Set aside Color A (no need to cut) and attach Color B for the heel.
k1, turn
Row 2 (WS): S1, PM, p up to last heel stitch, turn
Row 3 (RS): S1, PM, k up to next marker, RM, turn
Row 4 (WS): S1, PM, p up to next marker, RM, turn

Repeat rows 3 & 4 until **10** (**10**, **12**, **12**) center heel stitches remain between markers (after turning to RS and slipping and placing the marker)

Second half:
Row 1 (RS): S1, PM, knit up to next marker, RM, MM1, turn
Row 2 (WS): wyif S1, PM, purl up to next marker, RM, MM1, turn
Row 3 (RS): S1, PM, knit up to next marker, RM, ssk, MM1, turn
Row 4 (WS): wyif S1, PM, purl up to next marker, RM, p2tog, MM1, turn

Repeat rows 1 & 2 until there are 2 stitches remaining outside of the markers on each side after placing marker on RS.

Knit to next marker, RM, k2tog.

Do second heel in the same manner.

LEG

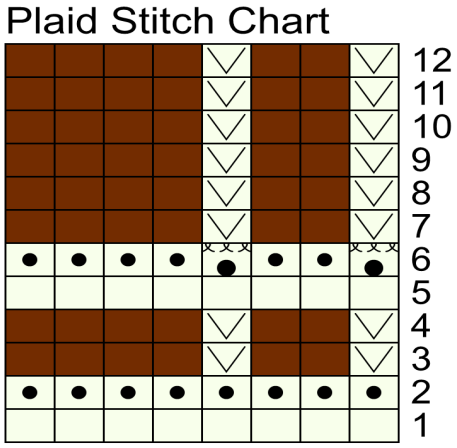
With Color A, knitting in the round.

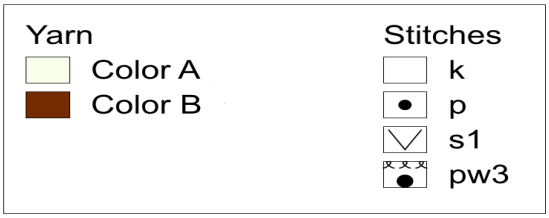
Front of leg, both socks: Knit across all stitches
Back of leg, both socks: K2tog, RM, knit across remaining stitches

Continuing with Color A, work next 10 rounds in stockinette (knit all stitches, in the round).

The rest of the leg will be done in plaid stitch (see plaid stitch chart and instructions below), repeated all the way around the leg.

Repeat all rows of plaid chart 1-3 times, until leg is close to desired length (minus 1.5” [4 cm] or so), ending on Row 5.





Round 1: K8 in A.
Round 2: P8 in A.
Rounds 3-4: [S1 in A, k2 in B] twice, k2 in B.
Round 5: K8 in A.
Round 6: [Pw3 in A, p2 in A] twice, p2 in A.
Rounds 7-12: [S1 in A, k2 in B] twice, k2 in B.

Repeat rows 1& 2 of chart once more.

Knit 5 rows of Stockinette in Color A

CUFF (with Color B and smaller needle): Work (k2, p2) rib for 8-12 rows (or more, if desired).

Using larger needle, bind off using Jenny's surprisingly stretchy bind-off, or other STRETCHY bind off of your choosing.

Here is a video showing how to do the JSS bind-off:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=abBhe-JYmgI

Weave in ends.

Stitch Glossary

A	Color A
B	Color B
k	Knit.
k2tog	Knit 2 stitches together.
kfb	Knit into the front and then the back of stitch.
MM1	Modified make one. On knit (RS) row: Pickup both legs of stitch between stitches on right and left-hand needles, place on left needle and knit that stitch (leave on right-hand needle). On purl (WS) row: Pickup both legs of stitch between stitches on right and left-hand needles, place on left needle and purl that stitch (leave on right-hand needle).
p	Purl.
p2tog	Purl 2 stitches together.
PM	Place marker.
pw3	Purl with 2 extra wraps around needle (total of 3 wraps).
RM	Remove marker.
RS	Right side (public side) of sock.
s1	Slip 1: With the working yarn in back, insert the right needle into the next stitch as if to purl and transfer the stitch from the left needle to the right.
ssk	Slip next 2 stitches (one at a time), as if to knit, then knit those stitches together through the back loops.
Stockinette	Knit all stitches in the round.
WS	Wrong side (inside) of sock.
wyif	With yarn in front.

Copyright ©2016 FiberFrosting Designs, all rights reserved. Pattern may not be reproduced for any reason other than your own personal use for knitting the garment.